Lilith and the líl-spirits: Sumerian and Mesopotamian sources, with later layers

SLUG sumerian_lilith STATUS DRAFT RELIABILITY 4/5 LICENSE PD

Prepared by Lexicon · 11 November 2026 (America/Chicago) · Source language: Sumerian (primary); Akkadian, Biblical Hebrew, Jewish Babylonian Aramaic (later layers) · This is a **draft for Jacqueline's review**. It is not a READY pack, and it is not the official archive PDF.

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This pack's **quotable core** is **PD** or reusable with attribution: Thompson 1903, Montgomery 1913, Langdon 1923, the Masoretic wording of Isaiah 34:14, the KJV, the ancient wording of the cited Bavli passages, and a typographic transliteration of CDLI P469670 sign readings (credit CDLI, https://cdli.earth). Lexicon's literal and readable English is original to this draft. **ETCSL English, Kramer 1938, Geller 2016, Farber 2014, and modern Bible/Talmud/Zohar English are REFERENCE-ONLY and are not used as publishedTranslation.** ePSD2 is cited in short glosses (ORACC open data typically CC BY-SA). British Museum images of the Burney Relief are **LINK-ONLY**.

Import note: Layer sections below are named exactly for the Archive & Research Center `translations` table. A READY pack imports one translations row per `## passage` block. See `_templates/app-import-mapping.md`. Do not rename layer headings. Until a `lilith` or `mesopotamian` collection exists, do not force these rows into `ecclesiastical` except for the biblical, Talmudic, and bowl sources (those may use `collectionSlug: ecclesiastical` as in `sources.md`). **Do not import while `status` is draft and no READY file is present.**

How this pack is built. Four historical layers are kept apart and **scored separately**. Layer 1 (Sumerian / Mesopotamian) is the full passage work in this draft. Layers 2–4 are shorter overviews with sources and scores. Later Jewish, medieval, and modern figures named Lilith are not automatically the same being as the Sumerian *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂* or the Akkadian *lilītu*. The pack is historical and linguistic. It is respectful of later devotion and of living practitioners. It is not ritual instruction, and it does not teach worship or expulsion practice.

Dialect / variant notes

- **Dialect or register:** Layer 1 uses literary Sumerian (Old Babylonian copies of earlier narrative; first-millennium bilingual incantation Sumerian with Standard Babylonian Akkadian). Layer 2 uses Biblical Hebrew and Jewish Babylonian Aramaic. Layers 3–4 are medieval Hebrew / literary Aramaic and modern English reception. These are not one dialect and not one "Lilith language."
- **Manuscript variants:** The ḫalub-tree passage is cited from the CDLI composite Q000364 / P469670. Individual tablets can differ in a sign or in line order; this draft does not collate every witness. Thompson 1903 is an older edition of Utukkū Lemnūtu; Geller 2016 is the modern standard and is cited only. The King List line *lil₂-la₂* is itself a site of disagreement.

- **Script or orthography notes:** Sumerian is given in typographic transliteration from CDLI sign readings (sz → š, {gesz} → ĝeš, numeric subscripts as ₂ ₃ ₄, ḫ for the *h* series where that is the usual value). This is ORACC-style scholarly transliteration (languages.md), not a phonetic reconstruction of everyday speech. Hebrew uses standard pointed Masoretic spelling; SBL academic transliteration is used beside it (î, ê, ā, š).
- **Witness date / distance from original:** Sumerian narrative on Old Babylonian tablets; Utukkū Lemnūtu as a first-millennium series; Isaiah in the medieval Masoretic tradition of an Iron Age book; Bavli and bowls in late antique / early medieval witnesses; the Alphabet of Ben Sira and the Zohar in medieval and later copies. None of these is a photograph of an "original Lilith autograph," and they do not form a single chain of copies of one work.

Uncertainties

UNCERTAIN — whether the Sumerian *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂-ke₄* in *Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld* is "Lilith." Why: the phrase means, literally, "the young woman of the *líl*." Kramer 1938 treated her as Lilith; that equation is a modern scholarly claim, still debated, and Kramer's wording is REFERENCE-ONLY. Readings on the table: a líl-spirit maiden in Inana's tree, not yet the later Jewish Lilith; a direct ancestor of Akkadian *lilītu* and later Lilith. What would settle it: not a single find. Do not state either side as fact. [1] [8]

UNCERTAIN — *lil₂-la₂* as the father of Gilgamesh in the Sumerian King List. Why: Langdon 1923 read *lil-la* as "fool, imbecile, cripple," and also asked whether it might be a title of Dumuzi; others have heard a *lillu*-demon or "phantom." It is not agreed that this line calls Gilgamesh the son of a Lilith-figure. [5]

UNCERTAIN — the folk etymology Lilith < Hebrew *laylâ* ("night"). Why: the resemblance is real and already appealed to rabbinic readers, but the usual scholarly account derives the name from Sumerian *líl* (wind, breath, spirit). Thompson 1903, who is PD and is quoted below, already thought a derivation from *laylâ* improbable. Likely false as a historical etymology; still part of later reception. [3] [6] [14]

UNCERTAIN — identification of the Burney Relief (BM 2003,0718.1) as Lilith. Why: the plaque is uninscribed. Suggestions have included Lilith, Inana/Ishtar, and Ereshkigal. None is proven. The image is LINK-ONLY. Do not caption the plaque "Lilith" as fact. [11]

UNCERTAIN — what Isaiah's *lîlît* is, in its own poem. Why: a waste-dwelling being in a ruin oracle, later read as the demon Lilith, and in the KJV as "screech owl." The word is probably related to Akkadian *lilītu*, but Isaiah 34 is not a Sumerian myth and does not tell the Ben Sira story. [12]

Reliability scores (four layers)

Overall front-matter score **4/5** is the score of **layer 1**, the primary work of this pack. Layers 2–4 are scored on their own and must not inherit layer 1's number. The cap rule applies inside each table: overall may not sit more than one point above the lowest criterion. Criteria: _templates/reliability-rubric.md .

Layer 1 — Sumerian / Mesopotamian (primary): 4/5

Criterion	Score	Note
Source quality	4	CDLI composite with credit, plus Thompson 1903 and Langdon 1923, all reputable published witnesses. Not a 2016-critical edition of the incantation series (Geller is REFERENCE-ONLY).
Text condition	4	The ḫalub-tree stretch is complete in the composite used here. Some Thompson lines are broken or restored; that is flagged in the relevant passage.
Translation confidence	3	*ki-sikil lil₂-la₂*, *líl*, and King-List *lil₂-la₂* are lexically readable but interpretively open.
Scholarly consensus	3	Specialists agree that *líl* / *lilû* / *lilītu* names a class of wind- or spirit-beings, and that later Lilith is historically related in some way. They do not agree that the tree-maiden, the King-List father, or the Burney Relief "is Lilith."
Citation completeness	4	Passages are tied to CDLI, Thompson, Langdon, and ePSD2. ETCSL is used only as a locator.
License / legal status	4	Thompson, Langdon, and the CDLI sign text (with credit) are clear for a draft PDF. ETCSL, Kramer, Geller, and Farber are kept out of publishedTranslation. Not a 5, because the licence picture is mixed and images are excluded.
Witness date / distance	4	Old Babylonian tablets and a first-millennium series are in a normal range for these compositions, not autographs.

Overall: 4/5. A legally usable, well-documented Mesopotamian dossier, capped by live debate over how far these figures are "Lilith" (lowest criterion 3; cap allows 4).

Layer 2 — Talmudic / Jewish late antique: 4/5

Criterion	Score	Note
Source quality	4	Standard Masoretic Isaiah; standard Bavli pagination; Montgomery 1913 for the bowls.
Text condition	5	The short passages used here are complete.
Translation confidence	4	The Hebrew and Aramaic of these notices is largely standard. The sense of Isaiah's *lîlît* remains discussed.
Scholarly consensus	3	That late antique Judaism knows a female demon Lilith is not in serious doubt. How closely she equals Mesopotamian *lilītu*, and what Isaiah meant, remain discussed.
Citation completeness	4	Passages are cited to standard references and to Montgomery.
License / legal status	4	Biblical, Talmudic, and Montgomery 1913 wording is PD; Soncino and later bowl corpora are not used as published English.
Witness date / distance	3	Isaiah via the medieval MT of an Iron Age book; Bavli via later printed tradition of a late antique corpus; bowls are late antique objects.

Overall: 4/5. A clear late-antique dossier, capped by the distance of some witnesses and by the Isaiah debate (lowest criterion 3; cap allows 4).

Layer 3 — Medieval (Alphabet of Ben Sira, Zohar): 3/5

Criterion	Score	Note
Source quality	3	

Criterion	Score	Note
		The Alphabet story is well known, but this draft is an overview pending a packed transcription from a named PD printing. The Zohar is only surveyed; modern English is REFERENCE-ONLY.
Text condition	4	The medieval works survive in a usable textual tradition, with recension differences in the Alphabet.
Translation confidence	3	The Alphabet narrative is clear in outline; Zoharic Aramaic is difficult, and no PD English is packed here.
Scholarly consensus	3	Scholars agree that the "first wife" story is medieval, not biblical. Dating of the Alphabet and the exact shape of Zoharic Lilith traditions remain discussed.
Citation completeness	3	Overview citations are given; a later pack should quote a named PD Hebrew printing line by line.
License / legal status	3	PD printings exist and may be used later; this draft does not yet rest on a fully extracted PD Hebrew text of the Alphabet, and Zohar English remains restricted.
Witness date / distance	2	Medieval compositions in later copies, far from any Bronze Age *líl* text.

Overall: 3/5. A usable historical overview of medieval reception, capped by witness distance and by the still-thin packed text of this draft (lowest criterion 2; cap allows 3).

Layer 4 — Modern reclamation (feminist / occult): 3/5

Criterion	Score	Note
Source quality	3	The layer documents modern reception from named, checkable works and from widely attested contemporary practice. It is not a critical edition of an ancient text.
Text condition	4	The modern works referred to are complete and available.
Translation confidence	4	Modern English sources are not lexically obscure. The task is description, not decipherment.
Scholarly consensus	3	Historians agree that modern Lilith devotion and feminist midrash are modern. They do not treat those readings as evidence for Sumerian religion.
Citation completeness	3	Representative citations are given; this is an overview, not a bibliography of every modern current.
License / legal status	2	The works that define this layer are mostly still in copyright and are cite-only. That is expected, and it is why the layer is not packed with long quotations.
Witness date / distance	3	As a dossier of modern reception, the witnesses are contemporary or recent. As evidence for antiquity, the distance is total — and is not what this layer claims to score.

Overall: 3/5 as a **reception** dossier (lowest criterion 2, the licence limit on quotation; cap allows 3). This score is **not** a score for ancient history.

Ready-to-use summary (Archivist / content bots)

- **One-line takeaway:** In Sumerian narrative, a *ki-sikil lil$_2$-la$_2$* — a "young woman of the *líl*" — nests in Inana's ḫalub-tree and is driven out to the waste places; Akkadian incantations name a related class, *lilû / lilītu / ardat-lilî*, as spirits to be expelled, not worshipped. Later Jewish Lilith, the medieval "first wife" story, and modern reclamation are later layers, not the same source.

- **Safe to quote:** Thompson 1903 (PD), e.g. the expulsion lines, “Thou shalt have no food to eat, Thou shalt have no water to drink,” *Utukki Limnuti* Tablet IV, p. 45. Also KJV Isaiah 34:14 (PD), with a note that “screech owl” stands for Hebrew *lîlît*. Lexicon’s readable English may be quoted once Jacqueline accepts this draft; it is not Thompson, ETCSL, or Kramer.
- **Pronunciation guide:** *líl* approximately “leel” (reconstruction, labelled as such). *ki-sikil* “kee-SI-kil.” *lilītu* “li-LEE-too.” Hebrew *lîlît* “lee-LEET.” *Lilith* in English “LIL-ith.”
- **Do not say as fact:** that the ḫalub-tree maiden “is Lilith”; that Gilgamesh’s father was a Lilith-demon; that the Burney Relief is Lilith; that Lilith comes from Hebrew *laylâ* “night”; that Mesopotamian texts prescribe bread, honey, or incense as devotional offerings to Lilītu; that the Alphabet of Ben Sira is a biblical source; that modern practice is evidence for Sumerian cult.
- **Hand-off notes:** Draft for Jacqueline’s review; no READY file; no ritual or worship instruction. Respect practitioners, including those who honor Lilith today, and keep that honor in layer 4. Human-sacrifice disclaimer is in the offerings section and is factual, not a lecture.

Key terms

Term	Script / spelling	Translit.	Meaning(s)	Lexicon / source
líl	lil_2	líl	Wind, breath, air, spirit, haunt	ePSD2 s.v. lil_2 [6]
ki-sikil	ki-sikil	ki-sikil	Young woman, maiden	ePSD2 s.v. ki-sikil [6]
ki-sikil lil-la	ki-sikil lil_2-la_2	ki-sikil lil_2-la_2	“Young woman of the líl”	GEN, CDLI Q000364:44, 142 [1] [2]
lilû	li-lu-u	lilû	Male spirit of this class (Akkadian)	Thompson 1903 [3]
lilītu	li-li-tum / lilitu	lilītu	Female counterpart	Thompson 1903 [3]
ardat-lilî	ar-da-at li-li-i	ardat-lilî	“Maiden of the lilû”; often a restless, marriage-age female spirit	Thompson 1903 [3]
lîlît	לִילִית	lîlît	The being named in Isaiah 34:14	MT / WLC [12]
Lilith	לילית	Lîlît / Lilith	Later Jewish and modern English name	Layers 2–4
ḫalub	{ĝeš}ha-lu-ub_2	ḫalub (huluppu in older literature)	The tree in Inana’s garden	GEN [1]; species identification (willow, etc.) is not settled
laylâ	לַיְלָה	laylâ	“Night.” Folk etymology of Lilith UNCERTAIN / likely false as history	Thompson 1903 already doubted it [3]

passage: 1

SOURCE_REF 1 · PASSAGE_ID gen_halub_40-46 · LABEL Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld, CDLI Q000364 lines 40–46 (ḫalub tree)

layer: originalText

(Typographic transliteration of CDLI sign readings; see transliteration layer. No cuneiform font is packed in this draft.)

mu 5-am₃ mu 10-am₃ ba-e-zal-la-ri
ĝeš ba-gur₄ kuš-bi nu-mu-un-da-dar
ur₂-bi-a muš tu₆ nu-zu-e gud₃ im-ma-ni-ib-us₂
pa-bi-a mušen anzu₄{mušen}-de₃ amar im-ma-ni-ib-gar
šab-bi-a ki-sikil lil₂-la₂-ke₄ e₂ im-ma-ni-ib-du₃
ki-sikil zu₂ bir₉-bir₉ ša₃ ḫul₂-ḫul₂
ku₃ {d}inana-ke₄ er₂ e-ne ba-še₈-še₈

layer: transliteration

mu 5-am₃ mu 10-am₃ ba-e-zal-la-ri
ĝeš ba-gur₄ kuš-bi nu-mu-un-da-dar
ur₂-bi-a muš tu₆ nu-zu-e gud₃ im-ma-ni-ib-us₂
pa-bi-a mušen anzu₄{mušen}-de₃ amar im-ma-ni-ib-gar
šab-bi-a ki-sikil lil₂-la₂-ke₄ e₂ im-ma-ni-ib-du₃
ki-sikil zu₂ bir₉-bir₉ ša₃ ḫul₂-ḫul₂
ku₃ {d}inana-ke₄ er₂ e-ne ba-še₈-še₈

Normalized from CDLI P469670 / Q000364 (credit: CDLI, https://cdli.earth). Line numbers match ETCSL 1.8.1.4 in this stretch, cited as a locator only.

layer: morphologyNotes

- mu 5-am₃ / mu 10-am₃: “it was five years, it was ten years.”
- ĝeš: “tree,” with the wood determinative in the source writing.
- ba-gur₄: “it became thick / massive.”
- ur₂-bi-a: “at its roots.”
- muš tu₆ nu-zu-e: “a snake that does not know incantations” (a snake immune to spells).
- gud₃ … us₂: “set a nest.”
- pa-bi-a: “in its branches.”
- anzu₄{mušen}: the Anzud (Anzû) bird.
- šab-bi-a: “in its middle / trunk” (šab, mid-section of the tree).
- ki-sikil: “young woman, maiden” (ePSD2 s.v. ki-sikil). [6]
- lil₂-la₂-ke₄: *líl* in the genitive, plus the ergative *-e* (written -ke₄): “the young woman of the *líl*.” *líl*: “wind, breath, spirit” (ePSD2 s.v. lil₂). [6] UNCERTAIN as an equation with later “Lilith.”
- e₂ … du₃: “built a house.”
- zu₂ bir₉-bir₉ ša₃ ḫul₂-ḫul₂: “laughing (with the teeth), the heart joyful.” Whether line 45 still describes the *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂* or is a broader epithet is UNCERTAIN.

• ku₃ {d}inana: “bright / holy Inana”; er₂ … še₈-še₈: “wept tears.”

layer: literalTranslation

> Five years, ten years having passed,
> the tree became thick; its bark could not be split.
> At its roots a snake that knew no incantation set a nest;
> in its branches the Anzud bird placed its young;
> in its trunk the young woman of the líl built a house.
> The young woman who laughs, the heart joyful —
> holy Inana, how she wept!
>
> Grounded in the CDLI sign text and in the ePSD2 citations above. Not ETCSL and not Kramer.

layer: readableTranslation

Five years, then ten years, went by. The tree grew thick, but its bark would not split. At its roots a snake that spells could not touch made a nest. In its branches the Anzud bird settled its young. In its trunk the young woman of the líl built herself a house. That laughing, glad-hearted young woman — and shining Inana wept.

This is Lexicon’s rendering. It does not call the tree-dweller “Lilith.”

layer: publishedTranslation

No public-domain line-for-line English is packed here. ETCSL English and Kramer 1938 are REFERENCE-ONLY and are not quoted. Use the literal and readable layers.

layer: publishedTranslationAttribution

Sign text: CDLI Literary 000364 (Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld) composite, P469670 / Q000364, lines 40–46, https://cdli.earth/artifacts/469670, consulted 11 November 2026. Credit: CDLI. ETCSL 1.8.1.4 is cited only as a line-number locator. Kramer, Assyriological Studies 10 (1938), REFERENCE-ONLY, not quoted.

layer: commentary

This is the earliest extended literary setting in which a *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂* appears: not as a goddess receiving a cult, and not as Adam’s first wife, but as one of three unwelcome inhabitants of a tree Inana had hoped to use for a throne and a bed. The other two are a spell-proof snake and the Anzud bird. Later tradition, and some modern scholarship (Kramer 1938, REFERENCE-ONLY), has called this figure Lilith. That is a possible historical connection and a live debate, not a fact established by the Sumerian wording. UNCERTAIN [1] [7] [8]

layer: userInterpretation

Leave empty. This layer is for Jacqueline or other users of the app, not for Lexicon.

passage: 2

SOURCE_REF 2 · PASSAGE_ID gen_halub_140-143 · LABEL Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld, CDLI Q000364 lines 140–143 (expulsion)

layer: originalText

> ur$_2$-bi-a muš tu$_6$ nu-zu-e sag ĝeš ba-an-ra
> pa-bi-a mušen anzu{mušen}-de$_3$ amar-bi šu ba-an-ti ŋur-sag-še$_3$ ba-an-ku$_4$
> šab-ba-bi-a ki-sikil lil$_2$-la$_2$-ke$_4$ e$_2$ im-ma-an-ni-in-zal
> e$_2$-ri-e$_2$-ri-še$_3$ ba-an-kar-kar-re

layer: transliteration

> ur$_2$-bi-a muš tu$_6$ nu-zu-e sag ĝeš ba-an-ra
> pa-bi-a mušen anzu{mušen}-de$_3$ amar-bi šu ba-an-ti ŋur-sag-še$_3$ ba-an-ku$_4$
> šab-ba-bi-a ki-sikil lil$_2$-la$_2$-ke$_4$ e$_2$ im-ma-an-ni-in-zal
> e$_2$-ri-e$_2$-ri-še$_3$ ba-an-kar-kar-re
>
> Normalized from CDLI P469670 / Q000364 (credit: CDLI, https://cdli.earth).

layer: morphologyNotes

- sag ĝeš … ra: “struck the head,” i.e. killed.
- šu ba-an-ti: “took (in hand).”
- ŋur-sag-še$_3$ ba-an-ku$_4$: “went into the mountain.”
- e$_2$ … zal: “brought the house to an end / dissolved / abandoned the house.” Exact nuance UNCERTAIN, but the house in the trunk does not remain.
- e$_2$-ri-e$_2$-ri-še$_3$: “to the waste places / deserted places.”
- kar-kar: “fled away” (reduplicated).

layer: literalTranslation

> At its roots he struck down the snake that knew no incantation.
> In its branches the Anzud bird took its young and went into the mountain.
> In its trunk the young woman of the líl brought her house to an end,
> and fled away to the waste places.
>
> Grounded in the CDLI sign text and in the ePSD2 citations above.

layer: readableTranslation

At the roots he killed the snake that spells could not touch. In the branches the Anzud bird took its young and went off to the mountain. In the trunk the young woman of the líl finished with her house and fled to the waste places.

Lexicon’s rendering, not ETCSL or Kramer.

layer: publishedTranslation

No public-domain line-for-line English is packed here. ETCSL English and Kramer 1938 are REFERENCE-ONLY and are not quoted.

layer: publishedTranslationAttribution

As passage 1: CDLI P469670 / Q000364, lines 140–143, https://cdli.earth/artifacts/469670. Credit: CDLI. ETCSL 1.8.1.4 locator only.

layer: commentary

Gilgamesh acts for Inana. The *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂* is not destroyed; she abandons the tree and flees to deserted places. That destination later rhymes, in a loose literary way, with Isaiah's *lîlît* settling in ruins, but the two texts are centuries apart and must not be collapsed. There is no offering, prayer, or cult scene in these lines. [2] [12]

layer: userInterpretation

Leave empty. This layer is for Jacqueline or other users of the app, not for Lexicon.

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passage: 3

SOURCE_REF 3 · PASSAGE_ID thompson_utukku_triad · LABEL Utukkū Lemnūtu, the líl triad (Thompson 1903)

layer: originalText

> (Sumerian, in Thompson's 1903 transcription, typographically tidied but not silently rewritten:)
>
> MULU-LIL-LA KI-EL-LIL-LA KI-EL-UD-DA KAR-RA
>
> (Akkadian correspondents, as Thompson gives them elsewhere in the same volume:)
>
> li-lu-u li-li-tum ar-da-at li-li-i

layer: transliteration

> lú-líl-la ki-el-líl-la ki-el-ud-da kar-ra
> lilû lilītu ardat-lilî
>
> *Ki-el* in Thompson's older notation is the same word as *ki-sikil*, "young woman." *Kar-ra* is "fleeing / driven off."

layer: morphologyNotes

- lú-líl-la (MULU-LIL-LA): "man / person of the *líl*" = Akkadian *lilû*.
- ki-el-líl-la: "young woman of the *líl*" = Akkadian *lilītu*. Compare the Sumerian *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂* of passages 1–2.
- ki-el-ud-da kar-ra: often equated with *ardat-lilî*, the "maiden of the *lilû*," a female spirit Thompson describes as more closely involved with human sexual life than *lilītu*. The equation of this third

Sumerian phrase with *ardat-lilî* follows Thompson's bilingual usage; a modern edition may refine the alignment (Geller 2016, REFERENCE-ONLY). UNCERTAIN in fine detail, not in the existence of the triad.

- Thompson already treats *lilû / lilītu / ardat-lilî* as a class of "malignant spirits" in expulsion series, not as cult deities. [3]

layer: literalTranslation

> The man of the líl, the young woman of the líl, the young woman who flees by (or is driven out in) daylight:
> the lilû, the lilītu, the ardat-lilî.
>
> Reading Thompson's bilingual text. Not Geller.

layer: readableTranslation

The male líl-spirit, the female líl-spirit, and the líl-maiden: in Akkadian, the lilû, the lilītu, and the ardat-lilî.

layer: publishedTranslation

Thompson does not always give a facing literary English for every list line. In the introduction to the same volume he names "LILU, LILITU, ARDAT LILI" among "various forms of malignant spirits," and he uses "Night-wraith" and "Handmaid of the Night-Phantom" for this class. Those are his 1903 English terms, not a line-for-line of the triad above. They are PD and may be quoted as such. His "night" language is a translation choice and does not prove the folk etymology from Hebrew *laylâ*.

layer: publishedTranslationAttribution

R. Campbell Thompson, *The Devils and Evil Spirits of Babylonia*, vol. 1 (London: Luzac, 1903), introduction and bilingual incantation plates (Utukki Limnuti). Public domain. Geller 2016 is the modern edition and is REFERENCE-ONLY, not quoted.

layer: commentary

This is the Mesopotamian incantation class later connected, carefully and not identically, with Hebrew *lîlît* and Jewish Lilith. Thompson thought *lilītu* was "undoubtedly the word from which the Hebrew Lilith was borrowed," while also doubting a derivation from *laylâ*, "night." Both parts of that sentence still belong on the table: a loan or shared *líl*-tradition is widely accepted; "Lilith means night" is UNCERTAIN and, as historical etymology, likely false. [3] [6] [9]

layer: userInterpretation

Leave empty. This layer is for Jacqueline or other users of the app, not for Lexicon.

passage: 4

SOURCE_REF 4 · PASSAGE_ID thompson_utukku_tabiv_food · LABEL Utukkū Lemnūtu, Tablet IV — food and water denied (Thompson 1903, p. 45)

layer: originalText

> (English of this passage is packed as publishedTranslation from Thompson. The corresponding Sumerian/Akkadian, in Thompson's transcription of the same Tablet IV incantation, includes the denial:)
>
> U BA-RA-AN-DA-AB-KU-E A BA-RA-AN-DA-AB-NAK-E
> GIŠ-BANSUR A-A MUH-ZU DINGIR-EN-LIL-LA-GE ŠU-ZU BA-RA-NE-IN-TUM

layer: transliteration

> u ba-ra-an-da-ab-ku-e a ba-ra-an-da-ab-nak-e
> ĝeš-bansur a-a muh-zu {d}en-líl-la-ke₄ šu-zu ba-ra-ne-in-tum
>
> "You shall not eat food; you shall not drink water. You shall not put your hand to the table of your father Enlil."

layer: morphologyNotes

- u: "food."
- a: "water."
- ba-ra-… : prohibitive / veto prefix, "you shall not."
- ku: "eat"; nak: "drink."
- ĝeš-bansur: "table."
- {d}en-líl: the god Enlil (here Thompson's "Bel"); not the *líl*-spirit, though the writings share the *líl* sign. Do not confuse the god Enlil with *lilû*.
- This is an **expulsion** formula, not a menu of gifts.

layer: literalTranslation

> You shall not eat food; you shall not drink water.
> You shall not carry your hand to the table of Enlil, your father.
>
> Aligned with Thompson's bilingual text.

layer: readableTranslation

Until you are gone, you are to have no food and no water, and you are not to put your hand to Enlil's table.

layer: publishedTranslation

(Whatever thou be) until thou art removed, Until thou departest from the body of the man, the son of his god, Thou shalt have no food to eat, Thou shalt have no water to drink. Thou shalt not stretch forth thy hand Unto the [table] of my father Bel, thy creator.

layer: publishedTranslationAttribution

R. Campbell Thompson, *The Devils and Evil Spirits of Babylonia*, vol. 1 (London: Luzac, 1903), Utukki Limnuti, Tablet IV, p. 45. Public domain.

layer: commentary

Packed here because the offerings question depends on it. In this series the exorcist **withholds** food and water from the invading spirit until it leaves the patient. That is the opposite of a devotional offering list. See the offerings section below. [4]

layer: userInterpretation

Leave empty. This layer is for Jacqueline or other users of the app, not for Lexicon.

---

passage: 5

SOURCE_REF 5 · PASSAGE_ID skl_gilgamesh_father · LABEL Sumerian King List, Gilgamesh's father lil$_2$-la$_2$ (Langdon 1923, WB 444)

layer: originalText

> {d}gilgameš
> ab-ba-ni lil$_2$-la$_2$
> en kul-aba$_4$-ke$_4$
> mu 126 i$_3$-ak

layer: transliteration

> {d}gilgameš
> ab-ba-ni lil$_2$-la$_2$
> en kul-aba$_4$-ke$_4$
> mu 126 i$_3$-ak
>
> Conventional scholarly transliteration of the Weld-Blundell prism line, as in the PD edition of Langdon 1923. ETCSL 2.1.1 may be used as a locator only.

layer: morphologyNotes

- {d}gilgameš: Gilgamesh, with the divine determinative.
- ab-ba-ni: "his father."
- lil$_2$-la$_2$: UNCERTAIN. The same *líl* writing as in passages 1–3, but the sense in a king list may be "lillu-demon / phantom," or Langdon's "fool, imbecile, cripple," or (Langdon also asked) a title connected with Dumuzi (*mu-lu-líl*).
- en kul-aba$_4$-ke$_4$: "the en (lord / priest) of Kulaba."
- mu 126 i$_3$-ak: "he exercised kingship for 126 years."

layer: literalTranslation

> Divine Gilgamesh —
> his father (was) lil_2-la_2 —
> the en of Kulaba —
> he exercised (kingship) for 126 years.
>
> The word *lil_2-la_2* is left untranslated on purpose.

layer: readableTranslation

Divine Gilgamesh, whose father was a lil_2-la_2, the en of Kulaba, reigned 126 years.

The title is not turned into “Lilith” or “fool” in the readable line; those are competing readings, not the wording of the list.

layer: publishedTranslation

Langdon 1923 discussed *lil-la* as “the fool, imbecile, cripple,” and also as a possible title of Tammuz/Dumuzi. That is his PD discussion, not a fact, and it is not the only reading. It may be cited; it is not adopted here as the translation.

layer: publishedTranslationAttribution

S. Langdon, *Oxford Editions of Cuneiform Texts* II, *Historical Inscriptions* (Oxford, 1923), on the Weld-Blundell prism WB 444. Public domain. ETCSL 2.1.1, locator only, REFERENCE-ONLY.

layer: commentary

This line has been drawn into Lilith discussions because it uses *lil_2-la_2*. That is not enough to make Gilgamesh the son of the tree-maiden or of later Jewish Lilith. UNCERTAIN, and flagged as such in the case-study method. [5] [7]

layer: userInterpretation

Leave empty. This layer is for Jacqueline or other users of the app, not for Lexicon.

The Burney Relief (not a passage)

The so-called Burney Relief, or “Queen of the Night,” British Museum 2003,0718.1, is an uninscribed Old Babylonian terracotta plaque of a winged female figure with bird talons, standing on lions, flanked by owls. It has been identified, at various times, as Lilith, as Inana/Ishtar, and as Ereshkigal. UNCERTAIN, and the uncertainty is strong: there is no caption on the object. This pack does not treat the plaque as a picture of Lilith. The Museum page is the public record; the image is **LINK-ONLY** and is not reproduced here.

https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/W_2003-0718-1

[11]

Offerings (informational only)

This section records **what the texts in this pack actually attest**. It is not a ritual manual, and it is not advice for practice. It is written with respect for people who honor Lilith today; their practice belongs in layer 4 and is not evidence for Sumerian or Akkadian cult.

What layer 1 attests. The Mesopotamian sources packed here are almost entirely **apotropaic**: they describe unwelcome presence (the tree, the sick body, the haunted place) and the driving-out or binding of that presence. They do not describe a temple cult of Lilītu, and they do not give a list of foods or incense to be offered to her in devotion.

- In *Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld*, the *ki-sikil lil₂-la₂* is expelled from Inana's tree. No gift is made to her. [1] [2]
- In Utukkū Lemnūtu as edited by Thompson, *lilû*, *lilītu*, and *ardat-lilî* appear in lists of harmful spirits. Tablet IV, in Thompson's PD English, tells the expelled being: "Thou shalt have no food to eat, Thou shalt have no water to drink," and forbids a hand stretched out to Enlil's table, until the spirit departs from the patient's body. [4]
- Thompson also notes that Labartu (Lamaštu) "has a whole series of texts written against her." The Lamaštu series, in the modern discussion (Farber 2014, REFERENCE-ONLY, not quoted), is the usual comparison for **figurines and provisions used to send a demon away**. That is expulsion, sometimes with a packet of supplies for the road, not worship of Lilītu. It must not be rewritten as a Lilītu offering menu, and this pack does not invent bread, honey, or incense lists that the Lilītu sources do not support. [10]

What layers 2–3 attest. Late antique and medieval Jewish texts in this pack are likewise protective, not cultic: Bavli warnings, bowl amulets "against the Liliths that haunt the house," and, in the Alphabet of Ben Sira, amulets that protect infants. Montgomery 1913 describes bowls as a "press" bound on demons, including in the four corners of a house. These are apotropaic objects and stories, not offerings *to* Lilith. [13] [14] [15]

What is not attested in any Lilītu or Lilith source in this pack. A canonical Mesopotamian or Jewish ritual of devotional offerings (bread, honey, incense, or similar) *to* Lilītu or Lilith is not in the sources reviewed here. If a later pack finds one, it should be added with a citation. Until then, the honest statement is that we do not have it.

Modern practice. Some contemporary practitioners do offer incense, wine, candles, or other gifts when they honor Lilith. That is **modern practice**. It is recorded in layer 4, with respect, and is not to be read back into Sumerian or Akkadian ritual. [17]

Human sacrifice is not attested in any Lilītu or Lilith source in this pack; it was a human practice in some ancient cultures and has no place in this archive's material.

Layer 2 — Talmudic and Jewish late antique (overview)

Isaiah 34:14 is the only occurrence of *lîlît* in the Hebrew Bible: a being that settles in a ruined landscape, among desert animals and the *śāʿîr*. The KJV's "screech owl" is a traditional English

rendering, not what the Hebrew word literally says. A relationship to Akkadian *lilītu* is widely accepted; identity of sense is UNCERTAIN. The verse does not tell the Ben Sira story. [12]

In the Babylonian Talmud, Lilith is already a named female demon, in short notices rather than a long myth:

- **Shabbat 151b:** a man should not sleep alone in a house, lest Lilith seize him.
- **Niddah 24b:** a discussion of an aborted fetus that looks "like Lilith" (later readers connect this with wings or long hair).
- **Eruvin 100b:** among traits discussed in connection with Eve and with women, growing hair "like Lilith."
- **Bava Batra 73a:** a travel tale mentions Hormin, son of Lilith, running on the walls of Mahoza.

English here is a short original summary of the standard pagination, not a Soncino quotation. [13]

Late antique incantation bowls from Nippur, in Montgomery 1913 (PD), treat Liliths as household dangers to be bound or driven out. Montgomery's English, of an amulet text in that volume, is:

> This is an amulet against the Liliths that haunt the house of this Ephra b. S. and this Bahmanduch b. S. I adjure you, all species of Liliths…

The bowls are inverted "presses." They are not gifts to Lilith. Object photographs remain LINK-ONLY. [14]

---

passage: 6

SOURCE_REF 12 · PASSAGE_ID isaiah_34_14 · LABEL Isaiah 34:14 (Masoretic lîlît)

layer: originalText

> וּפָגְשׁוּ צִיִּים אִֽי־אִיִּים וְשָׂעִיר עַל־רֵעֵהוּ יִקְרָא אַךְ־שָׁם הִרְגִּיעָה לִילִית וּמָצְאָה לָהּ מָנוֹחַ

layer: transliteration

> ûpāḡšû ṣiyyîm ʾet-ʾiyyîm wəśāʿîr ʿal-rēʿēhû yiqrāʾ ʾak-šām hirgîʿâ lîlît ûmāṣʾâ lāh mānôaḥ
>
> SBL academic transliteration of the standard Masoretic wording.

layer: morphologyNotes

- ṣiyyîm, ʾiyyîm: desert / howling beasts (exact species UNCERTAIN).
- śāʿîr: "goat-demon / satyr / shaggy one," itself a debated word.
- ʾak-šām hirgîʿâ lîlît: "indeed there the lîlît shall rest / settle."
- lîlît: hapax in the Hebrew Bible as this name. Related, in the usual scholarly account, to Akkadian *lilītu*, not derived from *laylâ* "night" as a proven etymology (UNCERTAIN / likely false). [3] [6] [12]
- mānôaḥ: "a resting place."

layer: literalTranslation

> And desert-beasts shall meet island-beasts (or: howling beasts shall meet each other), and the śāʿîr shall cry to his fellow; indeed there the lîlît shall settle and find for herself a resting place.

layer: readableTranslation

Wild creatures of the waste shall meet there, and the śāʿîr shall call to its companion; there too the lîlît shall come to rest, and find herself a place to settle.

The name is left as *lîlît*, not turned into “screech owl” and not expanded into the later Lilith story.

layer: publishedTranslation

The wild beasts of the desert shall also meet with the wild beasts of the island, and the satyr shall cry to his fellow; the screech owl also shall rest there, and find for herself a place of rest.

layer: publishedTranslationAttribution

Isaiah 34:14, King James Version (1611/1769). Public domain. “Screech owl” is the KJV’s English, not a transliteration of לִילִית.

layer: commentary

A ruin-oracle against Edom, not a treatise on demons and not a Sumerian tree story. Safe to quote the KJV if the Hebrew word is also named. UNCERTAIN what kind of being the poet pictured. [12]

layer: userInterpretation

Leave empty. This layer is for Jacqueline or other users of the app, not for Lexicon.

Layer 3 — Medieval (overview)

The **Alphabet of Ben Sira** (often dated, with debate, to about the 8th–10th centuries) is the source of the story most people now mean by “the Lilith story”: God creates Lilith as Adam’s first partner; she refuses a subordinate sexual position; she leaves; three angels (Senoy, Sansenoy, and Semangelof, in the usual form of the names) find her; she is associated with harm to newborns, except where an amulet bearing those names is used. This is medieval narrative, not Genesis, not Isaiah, and not the ḫalub-tree episode. It should be told as a later Jewish story of great afterlife, not as Bronze Age evidence. A later pack should transcribe a named PD Hebrew printing (for example Eisenstein, *Ozar Midrashim*, 1915, if that text is the one used) line by line. This draft only records the outline. [15]

The **Zohar** and related kabbalistic literature develop Lilith further, including as a partner of Samael in some passages, and as part of a wider map of holy and unholy femininity. Modern English translations are generally still in copyright and are not quoted here. No practical kabbalistic instruction is offered. [16]

Layer 4 — Modern reclamation (overview)

From the late nineteenth century onward, and with particular force in late twentieth-century feminist writing and in contemporary occult and Pagan practice, Lilith has been reclaimed as a figure of independence, refused submission, sexual autonomy, or a "dark goddess." Judith Plaskow's midrash "The Coming of Lilith" is a widely cited feminist text (in copyright; cite, do not quote at length). Historical surveys such as Raphael Patai's *The Hebrew Goddess* are likewise cite-only.

These readings are **modern perspectives**. They are recorded here with respect. They are not evidence for what the Sumerian tree episode, Isaiah 34, or an Akkadian incantation says. They may be personally meaningful, historically interesting as reception, and still distinct from layer 1.

Where modern practitioners offer incense, wine, candles, or other gifts to Lilith, that is **modern practice**. It is not attested as a Mesopotamian Lilītu cult in the sources of this pack, and it should not be back-projected onto Thompson or onto Inana's garden.

This archive does not teach how to worship, evoke, or expel Lilith.

Sources

Numbered entries live in `sources.md`. Short citations may also appear here:

1. CDLI Literary 000364, P469670 / Q000364, lines 40–46. Credit: CDLI, https://cdli.earth/artifacts/469670. See sources.md entry 1.
2. Same composite, lines 140–143. See sources.md entry 2.
3. Thompson, *Devils and Evil Spirits of Babylonia*, vol. 1 (1903). See sources.md entry 3.
4. Thompson 1903, Utukki Limnuti Tablet IV, p. 45. See sources.md entry 4.
5. Langdon, OECT II (1923), Sumerian King List, WB 444. See sources.md entry 5.
6. ePSD2, s.v. lil_2, ki-sikil. See sources.md entry 6.
7. ETCSL 1.8.1.4 and 2.1.1, locators only, REFERENCE-ONLY. See sources.md entry 7.
8. Kramer, AS 10 (1938), REFERENCE-ONLY. See sources.md entry 8.
9. Geller 2016, REFERENCE-ONLY. See sources.md entry 9.
10. Farber, *Lamaštu* (2014), REFERENCE-ONLY; Thompson's Labartu notices. See sources.md entry 10.
11. British Museum 2003,0718.1, LINK-ONLY. See sources.md entry 11.
12. Isaiah 34:14, MT and KJV. See sources.md entry 12.
13. b. Shabbat 151b; Niddah 24b; Eruvin 100b; Bava Batra 73a. See sources.md entry 13.
14. Montgomery, *Aramaic Incantation Texts from Nippur* (1913). See sources.md entry 14.
15. Alphabet of Ben Sira, medieval Hebrew narrative. See sources.md entry 15.
16. Zohar, overview only; modern English REFERENCE-ONLY. See sources.md entry 16.
17. Modern reception, cite-only. See sources.md entry 17.

Appendix: Sources

One numbered entry per `sources` table row. Field names match the template. Reliability scores below are pack-consistent with `pack.md` (scored per historical layer; see the four rubric tables). Fetched or checked 11 November 2026 (America/Chicago). Status of this pack: **draft**, not READY.

Source 1. Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld, CDLI Q000364 / P469670, lines 40–46 (ḫalub tree; ki-sikil lil_2-la_2-ke_4)

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Anonymous Sumerian poet(s); CDLI composite (P469670)
dateLabel	Composition early 2nd millennium BCE or slightly earlier; this witness tradition Old Babylonian (ca. 1900–1600 BCE); CDLI composite consulted 11 November 2026
yearApprox	-1800
language	Sumerian
originalLanguage	Sumerian
provenance	CDLI Literary 000364 composite, https://cdli.earth/artifacts/469670. Sign transliteration only, with credit to CDLI. Line numbers also used as locators for ETCSL 1.8.1.4 (REFERENCE-ONLY; ETCSL wording not used).
confidence	high
chronology	Old Babylonian copies of an earlier Sumerian narrative; not a photograph of a third-millennium autograph.
availability	open_access
rightsStatement	CDLI Terms of Use (consulted 11 November 2026): transliterations may be freely copied and re-used according to common and fair academic practice, with credit to CDLI and https://cdli.earth for considerable reuse. Images are not used (often NC / permission). ETCSL English and composite wording are REFERENCE-ONLY and are not packed.
description	The ḫalub-tree episode: a snake, the Anzud bird, and the ki-sikil lil_2-la_2-ke_4 take up dwellings in Inana's tree.
externalUrl	https://cdli.earth/artifacts/469670
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	Public digital transliteration; credit CDLI. Images LINK-ONLY / permission.
tags	["Sumerian", "Gilgamesh", "Inana", "lil", "CDLI"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 2. Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld, CDLI Q000364 / P469670, lines 140–143 (expulsion)

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Anonymous Sumerian poet(s); CDLI composite (P469670)
dateLabel	As source 1
yearApprox	-1800
language	Sumerian

originalLanguage	Sumerian
provenance	Same CDLI composite as source 1. Separate source number so the expulsion can be its own translations workspace.
confidence	high
chronology	As source 1.
availability	open_access
rightsStatement	As source 1.
description	Gilgamesh kills the snake; the Anzud bird takes its young to the mountain; the ki-sikil lil_2-la_2-ke_4 ends her house and flees to the waste places.
externalUrl	https://cdli.earth/artifacts/469670
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	As source 1.
tags	["Sumerian", "Gilgamesh", "Inana", "lil", "CDLI"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 3. Utukkū Lemnūtu (Utukki Limnuti), bilingual list of lilû / lilītu / ardat-lilî, in Thompson 1903

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Anonymous Mesopotamian exorcistic tradition; ed. and trans. R. Campbell Thompson
dateLabel	First-millennium Standard Babylonian series, from earlier tradition; this edition 1903
yearApprox	-700
language	Sumerian and Akkadian, with English translation
originalLanguage	Sumerian and Akkadian
provenance	R. Campbell Thompson, The Devils and Evil Spirits of Babylonia, vol. 1 (London: Luzac, 1903), bilingual incantation plates and introduction. PD. Internet Archive, devilsevilspirit01thomuoft, consulted 11 November 2026.
confidence	high
chronology	A first-millennium canonical series on tablets (Kouyunjik and others), not a Sumerian third-millennium hymn. Thompson's readings are those of a 1903 edition; Geller 2016 is the modern standard and is REFERENCE-ONLY.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	US and EU/UK PD (published 1903). Thompson's English may be used as publishedTranslation. Geller 2016 must not be quoted.
description	The named triad mulu-lil-la / ki-el-lil-la / ki-el-ud-da kar-ra, with Akkadian lilû, lilītu, ardat-lilî.
externalUrl	https://archive.org/details/devilsevilspirit01thomuoft
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	PD printed edition, digitized.
tags	["Akkadian", "Sumerian", "Utukku", "lilitu", "PD"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 4. Utukkū Lemnūtu, Tablet IV, denial of food and water to the expelled spirit (Thompson 1903)

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	As source 3
dateLabel	As source 3
yearApprox	-700
language	Sumerian and Akkadian, with English translation
originalLanguage	Sumerian and Akkadian
provenance	Thompson 1903, vol. 1, Utukki Limnuti Tablet IV, English at p. 45 of that edition (food and water denied until the spirit departs).
confidence	high
chronology	As source 3.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	PD, as source 3.
description	Apotropaic expulsion wording: the spirit is to have no food and no water until it leaves the patient's body. Evidence against a devotional offering list for these beings in this series.
externalUrl	https://archive.org/details/devilsevilspirit01thomuoft
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	PD printed edition, digitized.
tags	["Akkadian", "Sumerian", "Utukku", "apotropaic", "PD"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 5. Sumerian King List, Gilgamesh's father described as lil_2-la_2 (Langdon 1923, WB 444)

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Anonymous; ed. and trans. S. Langdon
dateLabel	Old Babylonian prism WB 444; this edition 1923
yearApprox	-1800
language	Sumerian, with English discussion
originalLanguage	Sumerian
provenance	S. Langdon, Oxford Editions of Cuneiform Texts II, Historical Inscriptions, containing principally the chronological prism W-B. 444 (Oxford, 1923). US PD (published 1923). The meaning of lil_2-la_2 is debated.
confidence	medium
chronology	Old Babylonian copy of a king-list tradition. The line is not a hymn to Lilītu.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	Langdon 1923 is US PD. ETCSL 2.1.1 may be cited as a locator only (REFERENCE-ONLY).
description	Gilgamesh, ab-ba-ni lil_2-la_2, en of Kulaba, reigned 126 years. Readings 'lillu-demon / phantom' and Langdon's 'fool, imbecile, cripple' (and a possible Dumuzi title) are both on the table.

repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	1923 PD edition; confirm a preferred digital scan when the pack is finalized.
tags	["Sumerian", "King List", "Gilgamesh", "PD", "UNCERTAIN"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	3

Source 6. ePSD2, selected entries (líl, ki-sikil, and related)

sourceType	scholarship
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	ePSD2 / ORACC contributors
dateLabel	Consulted 11 November 2026
yearApprox	2026
language	English (lexicon)
originalLanguage	Sumerian
provenance	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/ — ORACC open data are typically CC BY-SA 3.0. Short glosses only; do not dump entries.
confidence	high
chronology	Modern digital lexicon of Sumerian.
availability	open_access
rightsStatement	CC BY-SA 3.0 is the usual ORACC open-data licence (check the current ePSD2 footer if a later pack reuses long entries). Share-alike would apply to a substantial reuse of the lexicon text itself.
description	Lexicon for líl (wind, breath, spirit), ki-sikil (young woman), and related values used in morphologyNotes.
externalUrl	https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	Open digital lexicon; short cited glosses only.
tags	["ePSD2", "ORACC", "CC-BY-SA", "lexicon"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	5

Source 7. ETCSL 1.8.1.4 and 2.1.1 (line-number locators only)

sourceType	scholarship
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	ETCSL editors, University of Oxford
dateLabel	1998–2006
yearApprox	2006
language	English and Sumerian (electronic corpus)
originalLanguage	Sumerian
provenance	https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/ — editors' copyright 1998–2006.
confidence	high
chronology	

	Modern electronic corpus used here only as a standard reference for composition and line numbers.
availability	restricted
rightsStatement	REFERENCE-ONLY. Cite composition numbers and line numbers. Do not copy ETCSL English or composite wording into a pack PDF.
description	Locator for Gilgamesh, Enkidu and the Netherworld (1.8.1.4) and the Sumerian King List (2.1.1).
externalUrl	https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
tags	["ETCSL", "REFERENCE-ONLY"]
pdf	REFERENCE-ONLY
reliability	5

Source 8. Samuel N. Kramer, Gilgamesh and the Ḫuluppu-Tree (AS 10, 1938)

sourceType	scholarship
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Samuel N. Kramer
dateLabel	1938
yearApprox	1938
language	English (edition and translation)
originalLanguage	Sumerian
provenance	Oriental Institute, Assyriological Studies 10. In copyright. Consulted as the classic reconstruction that equated the ki-sikil lil_2-la_2 with ‘Lilith’.
confidence	high
chronology	Modern edition of an Old Babylonian Sumerian poem.
availability	restricted
rightsStatement	In copyright. REFERENCE-ONLY. Cite, do not quote at length, do not place in a pack PDF or in publishedTranslation.
description	Important historical edition. Its identification of the tree-dwelling maiden as ‘Lilith’ is a scholarly claim, not a fact, and is flagged in the pack.
externalUrl	https://isac.uchicago.edu/publications/gilgamesh-and-huluppu-tree-reconstructed-sumerian-text
tags	["Kramer", "REFERENCE-ONLY", "Sumerian"]
pdf	REFERENCE-ONLY
reliability	5

Source 9. Markham J. Geller, Healing Magic and Evil Demons (Utukkū Lemnūtu, 2016)

sourceType	scholarship
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Markham J. Geller
dateLabel	2016
yearApprox	2016
language	English (edition)
originalLanguage	Sumerian and Akkadian

provenance	Modern standard edition of the Utukkū Lemnūtu series. Consulted as the edition that supersedes Thompson 1903 for critical text; wording not imported.
confidence	high
chronology	Modern critical edition of a first-millennium series.
availability	restricted
rightsStatement	In copyright. REFERENCE-ONLY. Cite, do not quote.
description	Use to check Thompson; do not pack Geller's wording.
tags	["Geller", "Utukku", "REFERENCE-ONLY"]
pdf	REFERENCE-ONLY
reliability	5

Source 10. Walter Farber, Lamaštu (2014), and Thompson's Labartu notices

sourceType	scholarship
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Walter Farber; R. Campbell Thompson (older notices)
dateLabel	Farber 2014; Thompson 1903–1904
yearApprox	2014
language	English (modern edition); English/Akkadian (Thompson)
originalLanguage	Akkadian
provenance	Farber's Lamaštu is the modern edition of that series (REFERENCE-ONLY). Thompson 1903 notes that Labartu (older spelling of Lamaštu) has a series of texts written against her. Used only as a comparative apotropaic context, not as a Lilītu offering list.
confidence	high
chronology	First-millennium Mesopotamian anti-Lamaštu rituals; modern edition 2014.
availability	restricted
rightsStatement	Farber 2014 is in copyright, REFERENCE-ONLY, not quoted. Thompson's 1903 remarks are PD and may be cited.
description	Comparative: expulsion rites, figurines, and provisions used to send Lamaštu away. Not evidence of a devotional cult of Lilītu.
tags	["Lamashtu", "apotropaic", "REFERENCE-ONLY"]
pdf	REFERENCE-ONLY
reliability	4

Source 11. Burney Relief (British Museum 2003,0718.1), 'Queen of the Night'

sourceType	artifact
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Unknown Mesopotamian workshop
dateLabel	Old Babylonian, ca. 1800–1750 BCE (museum dating); acquisition record as BM 2003,0718.1
yearApprox	-1800
language	n/a (uninscribed relief)
originalLanguage	n/a
provenance	

	https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/W_2003-0718-1 — uninscribed terracotta relief of a winged, taloned female figure. Identification as Lilith, Inana/Ishtar, or Ereshkigal is contested.
confidence	medium
chronology	Old Babylonian object; modern identification only.
availability	open_access
rightsStatement	Museum images are LINK-ONLY. Do not place BM photographs in a pack PDF without a written licence from the Museum.
description	Often popularly called a ‘Lilith relief.’ That identification is not agreed and must be flagged UNCERTAIN.
externalUrl	https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/W_2003-0718-1
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	Object page live; images LINK-ONLY.
tags	["Burney Relief", "LINK-ONLY", "UNCERTAIN"]
pdf	LINK-ONLY
reliability	2

Source 12. Isaiah 34:14 (Masoretic lîlît), with KJV English

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	ecclesiastical
author	Isaiah tradition; Masoretic Text; KJV translators
dateLabel	Hebrew composition, Iron Age (date debated); MT medieval; KJV 1611/1769
yearApprox	-700
language	Biblical Hebrew and English
originalLanguage	Biblical Hebrew
provenance	Standard Masoretic wording of Isaiah 34:14 (Leningrad / WLC type). KJV English is US PD and is used as publishedTranslation, with a note that ‘screech owl’ is a traditional English rendering, not a transliteration of lîlît.
confidence	high
chronology	A biblical poetic line in a prophecy against Edom, far later than the Sumerian ḫalub-tree episode, and not identical in sense with Akkadian lilītu.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	Biblical wording PD; KJV PD. Recent Bible versions REFERENCE-ONLY and not used.
description	The single canonical Hebrew Bible occurrence of לִילִית.
tags	["Hebrew", "Isaiah", "lilit", "PD"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 13. Babylonian Talmud: Shabbat 151b, Niddah 24b, Eruvin 100b, Bava Batra 73a

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	ecclesiastical
author	Babylonian rabbinic tradition
dateLabel	Late antique (redacted ca. 6th–7th c. CE); standard printed pagination (Vilna type)

yearApprox	600
language	Hebrew and Jewish Babylonian Aramaic
originalLanguage	Hebrew and Jewish Babylonian Aramaic
provenance	Standard Bavli pagination. The ancient wording is not in copyright. English in this pack is a short original rendering, not Soncino or another modern version (those remain REFERENCE-ONLY).
confidence	high
chronology	Late antique rabbinic discussion, not a Bronze Age source, and not the Alphabet of Ben Sira.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	Talmudic wording PD. Soncino and most 20th-c. English REFERENCE-ONLY, not used as publishedTranslation.
description	Short notices: sleeping alone (Shabbat 151b); a fetus ‘like Lilith’ (Niddah 24b); hair like Lilith (Eruvin 100b); Hormin son of Lilith (Bava Batra 73a).
tags	["Talmud", "Lilith", "Aramaic", "PD"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 14. J. A. Montgomery, Aramaic Incantation Texts from Nippur (1913), Lilith bowls

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	ecclesiastical
author	J. A. Montgomery, editing late antique bowls from Nippur
dateLabel	Bowls late antique (ca. 5th–7th c. CE); this edition 1913
yearApprox	500
language	Jewish Babylonian Aramaic, with English translation
originalLanguage	Jewish Babylonian Aramaic
provenance	Philadelphia: University Museum, 1913. US PD. Includes amulet texts ‘against the Liliths that haunt the house’ and, as no. 42, a form of a Lilith legend used as an exorcism of names. Object photographs are not packed (LINK-ONLY).
confidence	high
chronology	Late antique household apotropaia, roughly contemporary with the Bavli milieu, not first-millennium Mesopotamian temple ritual.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	1913 edition US PD. Later bowl corpora (Naveh/Shaked, Levene, and others) REFERENCE-ONLY. Images LINK-ONLY.
description	Bowls are presses / amulets to bind or drive Liliths from a house. They are not devotional offerings to Lilith.
externalUrl	https://archive.org/details/aramaicincantati00montuoft
repositoryAccessStatus	digitized
repositoryAccessNote	PD printed edition. Images of bowls LINK-ONLY.
tags	["Aramaic", "incantation bowls", "Lilith", "PD"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	4

Source 15. Alphabet of Ben Sira, Lilith episode (medieval Hebrew narrative)

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	ecclesiastical
author	Anonymous medieval Hebrew author(s)
dateLabel	Often placed ca. 8th–10th c. CE (date debated); early printings and Eisenstein, Ozar Midrashim, 1915, are US PD where the printing is pre-1931
yearApprox	900
language	Hebrew
originalLanguage	Hebrew
provenance	Medieval narrative, not a biblical book. A PD printing (e.g. Eisenstein 1915) may be used for Hebrew when the pack is expanded; this overview does not paste a long modern English. Recent annotated translations are REFERENCE-ONLY.
confidence	medium
chronology	Medieval. This is the source of the well-known ‘first wife of Adam’ story, not Isaiah and not the Sumerian tree episode.
availability	public_domain
rightsStatement	Narrative is not in copyright; use a named pre-1931 printing for any packed Hebrew. Modern English translations REFERENCE-ONLY.
description	Lilith as Adam’s first partner; she refuses a subordinate sexual position, leaves, and is associated with harm to infants except where an amulet of three angels is present.
tags	["Ben Sira", "medieval", "Lilith", "PD"]
pdf	PDF-OK
reliability	3

Source 16. Zohar, selected later notices of Lilith (overview only)

sourceType	primary
collectionSlug	ecclesiastical
author	Zoharic authors (late 13th c. Castile, in the usual scholarly account)
dateLabel	Late 13th century, with later transmission and printings
yearApprox	1290
language	Aramaic (literary)
originalLanguage	Aramaic
provenance	Early printings (Mantua, Cremona, and later PD typesets) may be PDF-OK for Aramaic once a named printing is used. Modern English (Matt; Soncino Sperling/Simon, etc.) is typically still in copyright — REFERENCE-ONLY, not quoted here.
confidence	medium
chronology	Medieval kabbalistic literature, centuries after the Bavli and the Alphabet of Ben Sira.
availability	restricted
rightsStatement	Modern English REFERENCE-ONLY. This pack gives only an overview, without packing a modern translation.
description	Later kabbalistic development (Lilith in relation to Samael and to a demonized feminine), reported as a medieval tradition, not as evidence for Sumerian religion and not as practical instruction.
tags	["Zohar", "medieval", "REFERENCE-ONLY"]

pdf	REFERENCE-ONLY
reliability	3

Source 17. Modern reclamation and practice (feminist, occult, and related), overview only

sourceType	scholarship
collectionSlug	mesopotamian
author	Various modern authors and practitioners (see pack; cited, not quoted at length)
dateLabel	Especially from the late 19th century to the present
yearApprox	1972
language	English and other modern languages
originalLanguage	n/a
provenance	Reception history only. Includes feminist midrash (e.g. Judith Plaskow, ‘The Coming of Lilith’) and modern occult or Pagan honor of Lilith as a figure of independence or a dark goddess. These are modern perspectives, not evidence for what a Sumerian or Akkadian text says. In-copyright works are cite-only.
confidence	high
chronology	Modern. Must not be read back into layer 1.
availability	restricted
rightsStatement	Typically all-rights-reserved. REFERENCE-ONLY. Cite, do not quote at length, do not pack as ancient evidence.
description	Modern offerings (incense, wine, candles, and similar), when they occur, belong here as modern practice.
tags	["modern reception", "REFERENCE-ONLY"]
pdf	REFERENCE-ONLY
reliability	3